

would allow you put your smartphone and the average tripod together. That was until Joby's GripTight came in to the scene.

Now before you say 'I'm sure it works only on the iPhone,' let me point out that it works with any phone that is between 2.1 to 2.8 inches on the short side. It even works with most cases slapped on to the smartphone. It is small, folds away neatly in your pocket and is compatible with the standard sized screws found on tripod base plates.



Hold on tight!

You could also take a look at Square Jellyfish's spring tripod mount. It accommodates larger phones of up to 3.5 inches on the short side and can go from 'vertical to horizontal in seconds'. It's got a ball head design which the GripTight doesn't have and they've also got a whole bunch of accessories that go with this accessory.

Last but not least on the matter of stability would be the smartphone monopod or the Quikpod. Better known as the smartphone selfie stick, its use is best experienced if you are socially awkward and wouldn't dare ask people if they would take your picture. Back packing through a country where the crime rates are through the roof is a close second. It is basically a monopod with a mirror on it so you can position yourself and take full advantage of the hi-mega pixel sensor on the back of your phone instead of the potato on the front.

If your wallet is your major constraint, Tina Sieber from makeuseof.com has a solution for you. With some duct tape, a hex nut, a binder clip, pliers and your tripod's base plate, Tina claims you can build your own tripod mount in under a minute.

Step one would be to wrap the binder clip with duct tape so that it doesn't scratch your phone. Make sure that the fit is good and not too tight.

With the pliers, get rid of the washer that's keeping the base plate's screw in place and throw in a longer screw with a hex nut.

Thread one of the binder clip's handles in to the screw and tighten the hex nut to hold it in place. You might need to bend the handle a little bit and your DIY tripod mount is ready. Just watch out for how tight the binder clip is. There's another DIY tripod mount put up by Tina on the website that's a little more complex but not worth giving a miss.